

TravMobile Reverse Auction Bidding Model - Edge Cases

1 Bidding & Auction Process - Edge Cases

Edge Case 1: No Bids Placed

Scenario: No vendors place a bid within the auction time limit.

Solution:

- The query is flagged to Super Admin at T-15 Minutes mentioning that there is no bid placed for this query.
- The Super Admin has three intervention options:
 1. **Manually place a bid** on behalf of a vendor to ensure continuity.
 2. **Extend the auction time** to allow more vendors to participate.
 3. **Reject and resubmit the request** with modified parameters to make it more attractive to vendors.
- A history log is maintained to track these actions.

Edge Case 2: Vendors Place Bids but Do Not Fulfill

Scenario: Vendors frequently place the lowest bid but later cancel, leading to disruptions.

Solution:

- A **Vendor Credibility Score** system is implemented:
 - Scores are based on bid consistency, fulfillment rate, and reviews.
 - Vendors with poor scores receive fewer priority requests.
 - The score is visible only to the Super Admin.
- Vendors with repeated cancellations are penalized with:
 - Temporary bidding restrictions.
 - Monetary fines based on cancellation frequency.
 - Permanent bans for extreme cases.

Edge Case 3: Accidental or Irrelevant Bids

Scenario: Vendors submit incorrect bids due to human error or misunderstanding of requirements.

Solution:

- A **confirmation pop-up** appears before bid submission, requiring vendors to verify their pricing and conditions.
 - Vendors can only edit or cancel bids within a **2-minute grace period** post-submission.
 - Any bid withdrawal after the grace period results in a credibility score deduction.
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2 Modification Request Flow - Edge Cases

🛑 Edge Case 1: Lowest Bidder Cannot Modify the Quote

Scenario: The vendor with the lowest bid is unavailable or unable to make modifications.

✅ Solution:

- The request is **automatically forwarded to the next 5 lowest bidders**.
- If none of the next 5 bidders accept, the Super Admin is alerted to decide the next steps.

🛑 Edge Case 2: Excessive Modification Requests

Scenario: Travel agents repeatedly request modifications, causing inefficiencies.

✅ Solution:

- A **modification limit** per booking is introduced (configurable in the admin panel).
 - Beyond the free limit, modifications are chargeable.
 - Vendors can see the number of past modifications before accepting a request.
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3 Payment & Cancellation Policies - Edge Cases

🛑 Edge Case 1: Vendor Cancels After Accepting the Booking

Scenario: A vendor cancels a booking last minute, causing travel disruptions.

✅ Solution:

- **Immediate penalty deduction** from the vendor's account balance.
- The booking is automatically reassigned to the next lowest bidder.
- The Super Admin is notified for high-value or urgent bookings.

🛑 Edge Case 2: Travel Agent No-Show

Scenario: The travel agent does not show up or cancels after the booking is confirmed.

✓ **Solution:**

- **Non-refundable deposit policy** enforced.
 - Vendor compensation for wasted resources (configurable by the Super Admin).
 - Travel agents with repeated no-shows receive a lower credibility rating.
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4 Document Handling & Security - Edge Cases

🔴 Edge Case 1: Unauthorized Document Sharing

Scenario: Vendors and travel agents try to exchange details outside TravMobile to bypass the platform.

✓ **Solution:**

- **Super Admin approval** is required for any document exchange.
- A **watermark system** imprints TravMobile branding on all shared documents.
- Unauthorized attempts trigger a compliance review, and violators receive warnings or penalties.

🔴 Edge Case 2: Difficulty in Retrieving Old Documents

Scenario: Travel agents or vendors struggle to find past documents.

✓ **Solution:**

- **Search, Sort & Filter Feature** added for efficient document retrieval.
 - File naming follows a structured format:
`Unique_ID-Traveller_Name-Destination.`
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5 Ensuring Vendor Compliance & Quality Control - Edge Cases

🔴 Edge Case 1: Vendors Consistently Deliver Poor Service

Scenario: Some vendors repeatedly receive bad ratings but still participate in auctions.

✓ **Solution:**

- A **performance tracking dashboard** ranks vendors based on:
 - Completion rate
 - Customer reviews
 - Cancellation history
- Vendors with low scores receive fewer booking opportunities.

Edge Case 2: Disputes Between Vendors and Travel Agents

Scenario: Conflicts arise over pricing, services, or fulfillment.

Solution:

- **Dispute resolution center** integrated within the platform.
 - Both parties submit their claims, and the Super Admin mediates.
 - Email and **24/7 support** handle urgent cases.
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6 Communication & Transparency - Edge Cases

Edge Case 1: Vendors Miss Bid Deadlines

Scenario: Vendors fail to submit bids on time due to oversight.

Solution:

- Automated **reminder pop-ups** notify vendors before the deadline.
- **Escalation notifications** are sent for high-value queries.

Edge Case 2: Travel Agents Forget Upcoming Queries

Scenario: Travel agents fail to follow up on their requests.

Solution:

- A **T-1 Day Reminder** notifies both vendors and travel agents about upcoming queries.
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Summary of Key Enhancements:

 Vendor credibility scoring system for better decision-making.  Search, sort, and filter functionality for document retrieval.  Vendor rating of travel agents for balanced feedback.  T-1 day reminders to enhance responsiveness.  Penalty framework for non-compliant vendors and agents.